



Intel tinkers around

Intel is preparing a microcode update to enhance the overclocking of their 10th Gen Core i9 XE processors. <https://dgit.in/dec19-03>



Twitter to clean house

Twitter is issuing warnings to inactive users about removing inactive accounts in December. <https://dgit.in/dec19-04>

microphone) so you don't have to pick and choose the individual components. Since we already have some of the components, we decided to skip that one.

Then there's the Zoom UAC-2 which has USB 3.0, MIDI support, two XLR inputs but only gain and no button for padding. You can still play around with the gain to achieve the same effect as padding so the Zoom UAC-2 is a good candidate. Then we had the M-Audio M-Track 2x2 which we decided to skip since it only had one XLR input. Lastly, we had to check out the Behringer U-

Phoria UMC204HD and the Focusrite Scarlett 2i2 (Gen3). The Focusrite unit doesn't have a MIDI interface but aside from that the feature set is practically the same as the Behringer and the Zoom units. Focusrite is a Mac-centric device and their windows software gets updated much later than the Mac version, so it was a bit of a gamble for us. If a software bug would have to be updated, then waiting extra time for being on the Windows ecosystem wasn't fair. So we decided to skip that and pick the Behringer U-Phoria UMC204HD

for having the most comprehensive feature set of them all and also for being cheaper overall. The Zoom UAC-2 was our second choice.

Out came the credit card and the purchase was made. Setting up the device was quite easy and the built in software was quite simple to work with. This made it ideal for someone starting out with podcasts. Soon enough, you'll see my buddy yapping away on mundane topics on his podcast. I'll let you guys know if I'm going to be invited as a guest anytime soon. 

BUYING ADVICE

DREAM MACHINE

Q Dear AGENT001, I have been reading DIGIT for 4 years now. It has really helped me to know and learn technical things. I need advice to buy a new system. I want a new PC for 65% gaming and 35% work. Work such as installing software, video and lighting planning software, etc. and using them just for knowledge purpose. I have a budget of 150K. Please help me with the best performance oriented system that lasts for a long time. Also please consider these things:

- 1 I don't need any kind of RGB
- 2 I need a Mid-tower cabinet with front panel dust filters and extra fans in front or back but cabinet shouldn't be very pricey, if possible
- 3 I already have a 1 TB HDD in my older laptop + 1TB External HDD
- 4 I already have mouse and keyboard

I went through the Digit magazine and some videos on the internet and selected items as per my need but I'm not able to fit them under my budget also don't know if they are compatible.

- CPU - Intel Core i7-9700K 9th Gen
- Cooler - Noctua NH-U14SMoBo - ASUS PRIME Z390-P Gen 2
- RAM - Corsair Vengeance LPX 2x 8GB DDR4 3200MHz
- HDD - Seagate 2TB Barracuda 7200RPM

- SSD - Samsung 970 Pro 512GB
- GPU - NVIDIA GeForce RTX 2070 SUPER 8GB
- Cabinet - Fractal Design Define R6
- PSU - Cooler Master MasterWatt 650W
- Monitor - LG 27UK650

I've opted for an Intel CPU because some videos and tech forums have expressed that the i7-9700K is better than Ryzen7 3700X by some margin. Also people say that Ryzen 7 is good when it comes to rendering but for games and overall performance the i7-9700K is ahead. I also want to ask some questions:

- a) Better investment > M.2 NVMe SSD or 1TB SATA 2.5-inch SSD?
- b) Is not having Hyper-Threading bad in the long run?
- c) Can I get a 1TB SSD for about 15k?

This is going to be a DREAM PC for me and it took time to accumulate the money. Finally it is up to you to decide the best RIG for me, I will follow what you suggest me to buy.

Thank you in advance for helping me with my soon to be new system.

—Apprentice001



A My Apprentice, You've got a lot of the components figured out properly. All that remains is to make a few minor compromises that'll ensure you don't take a performance hit but the price should come down quite a bit. When it comes to gaming, the Intel processors are still a

little ahead but that 2-3% isn't that big a deal. Most of the heavy lifting is done by the graphics card. There are very few games in which Intel has an advantage, so giving up multi-threading isn't exactly a prudent decision if you're thinking long term. A Ryzen 7 3800X would be better with most tasks associated with your workloads. Coming to your configuration, you can swap out the Samsung 970



Samsung 970 Evo 500GB

Pro for a cheaper alternative such as the 970 Evo which can save you some money. Also, there are M.2 SSDs which use fewer PCIe lanes and have slow controllers. The combination of which are barely faster than 2.5-inch SATA SSDs. However, if you were to check out something like the 970 EVO, then they are way faster when handling file transfers. You can get good 1 TB SSDs for 15K during sales or you can get cheaper models such as the 1TB MX500 for ₹9,199. Coming back to your PC, the Fractal Design cases go out of stock quite regularly so the NZXT H710 or the H510 would be ideal replacements if you can't get the Fractal R6. This should all help you get everything within budget. Also, make sure to get your PC from reputed dealers at Lamington Road or Nehru Place or Mount Road, etc. 